

Conflict of Interest Policy for USC Paid Employees

Policy Summary & Knowledge Check

Authority	Chief Operating Officer
Date Ratified	April 28, 2025
Next Review Date	April 2028
Previous Amendments	February 2, 2024; February 2021
Delegate(s)	Senior Manager, People and Development

Policy Summary

This policy reflects the USC's commitment to guarding against conflicts of interest among paid employees, including those compensated through honoraria. It defines conflict of interest, assigns administration to the Senior Manager, People and Development (or the COO if conflicted), and sets expectations that personal gain must never conflict with an employee's duty to the USC. It also limits paid employees to holding one USC position at a time, restricts certain paid staff from running for specific elected or appointed positions while employed, and directs that corporate resources never be used for personal or political gain.

Key Takeaways

- Applies to all paid USC employees, including those compensated through honoraria (full-time staff, Coordinators, AVPs, Interns, Orientation Staff, Elections Governance Board Members, Executive Officers, and Gazette members).
- Conflict of interest means being involved in multiple interests, financial or otherwise, where serving one could work against or benefit from another.
- The Senior Manager, People and Development administers the policy; the COO steps in if that role is conflicted.
- Paid employees may hold only one USC position at a time; unpaid volunteers may hold multiple unpaid volunteer positions.
- Certain paid staff, LST members, and Faculty Sophs may not apply or run for USC Councillor, Director, Purple Care Trust Student Trustee, or Appeals Board Member while holding their paid position.
- Paid employees applying for a hired executive position are not required to take a leave of absence, as this is treated as an internal hiring process.
- Corporate resources must never be used for personal or political gain.
- Consultations regarding USC hired and elected student leadership positions must go through the President and Vice-Presidents.

Knowledge Check

4 situational questions to check understanding of this policy. An answer key follows on the next page.

Q1. An employee paid through honoraria wants to take on a second, separate paid USC staff role at the same time. Is this permitted?

- A.** No — paid employees, including those paid through honoraria, may hold only one USC position at a time.
- B.** Yes, with only verbal manager approval.
- C.** Yes, as long as combined hours stay under 40 per week.
- D.** Yes, as long as the two roles don't overlap in duties.

Q2. A paid staff member wants to run for USC Councillor while continuing in their current paid role. What does the policy say?

- A.** It's permitted since Councillor is an elected, not paid, position.
- B.** Paid employees may not apply or run for Councillor while holding their paid position.
- C.** It's permitted only with Board of Directors approval.
- D.** It's permitted after six months in the paid role.

Q3. A paid employee applies for a hired executive position with the USC. Must they take an unpaid leave of absence during the process?

- A.** Yes, for at least two weeks.
- B.** Yes, for the duration of the hiring process.
- C.** No — this is treated as an internal hiring process and no leave is required.
- D.** Only if they currently hold a Director role.

Q4. A department wants to consult on filling a USC elected student leadership position and isn't sure who to go through. Per the policy, who should this consultation go through?

- A.** The Senior Manager, Information Systems.
- B.** The Human Resources Committee only.
- C.** The Board of Directors directly.
- D.** The President and Vice-Presidents.

Answer Key

Q1: A — Section 5.1 states paid employees, including those paid through honoraria, shall hold one position with the USC at a time.

Q2: B — Section 5.3 prohibits certain paid staff from applying or running for USC Councillor (and other listed positions) while they hold their paid position.

Q3: C — Section 5.4 states paid employees applying for a hired executive position will not be required to take a leave of absence, as it is treated as an internal hiring process.

Q4: D — Section 5.6 states consultations for USC hired and elected student leadership positions shall go through the President and Vice-Presidents.